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God Is Good

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God Is Good

He is the source and definition of all goodness, delighting to bless His creation.

I Will Make All My Goodness Pass Before You (Exodus 33:19; 34:6)

“I will make all my goodness pass before your face, and I will proclaim the Lord by name before you.” When Moses asked to see God’s glory, the Lord answered with goodness. Goodness is not a side of God. It is the shining of who He is as He passes by.

You Are Good and You Do Good (Psalm 119:68; Psalm 34:8)

“You are good and you do good.” “Taste and see that the Lord is good! How blessed is the one who takes shelter in him!” He is not good only in name. He does good. The invitation is not to admire the word. It is to take refuge and find that the refuge is kind.

The Lord Is Good to All (Psalm 145:9; Genesis 1:31)

“The Lord is good to all, and has compassion on all he has made.” “God saw all that he had made—and it was very good.” Creation itself is the overflow of His goodness. He is not kind to a few and indifferent to the rest. What He makes, He blesses.

How Much More Will Your Father Give (Matthew 7:11; James 1:17)

“If you then, although you are evil, know how to give good gifts to your children, how much more will your Father in heaven give good gifts to those who ask him!” “All generous giving and every perfect gift is from above, coming down from the Father of lights.” Earthly fathers give imperfectly. The Father gives truly. Every good thing that reaches us has His name on it.

The Lord Is Good, a Stronghold in the Day of Trouble (Nahum 1:7; Romans 8:28)

“The Lord is good as a protective shelter in a day of distress.” “We know that all things work together for good for those who love God, who are called according to his purpose.” Goodness is not only fair weather. It is God Himself when the day is dark—still kind, still working what is truly good, even when the gift does not first look like one.

Daily Impact

Goodness means God is not merely useful or powerful. He is kind. What He is, He does. That frees us from the suspicion that His heart is against us when His hand is heavy. It also frees us from the smaller gods we build out of gifts—treating food, health, or success as the source, rather than as traces of the Father who gives good gifts.

Daily we learn to taste and see: to notice mercy in ordinary hours, to ask as children ask, and to call a thing good only if it matches His character. Gratitude becomes sane. Anxiety loses some of its argument. Even trouble is carried to the God who is a stronghold in the day of distress, and who works all things toward a good He has not abandoned.

Because God is good, I will trust His heart when His hand is heavy.

Questions for Personal Application

1. Where have I been doubting His heart—treating a hard providence as proof that He is something other than good?
2. What ordinary gift have I received this week that I have not yet traced back to the Father of lights?
3. How should “You are good and you do good” change the way I ask, wait, and give thanks today?
4. What am I calling “good” that would not stand if His character were the measure?
5. Whom can I remind that the Lord is a stronghold in trouble—not only a giver in easy days?

Word Pictures of God’s Goodness

The Glory That Passes as Goodness

Moses did not ask for an easier path. He asked to see God’s glory. The Lord did not answer with raw power alone. He said He would make all His *goodness* pass before him. That is the surprise of this attribute. The shining of God, when a man is allowed to stand near it, is not cruelty dressed as majesty. It is kindness so full it must be named as glory. When you wonder what God is like at the center, do not begin with a suspicion. Begin here: when He passes by, goodness is what fills the cleft of the rock.

Bread on a Child's Table

A father may be flawed and still know not to put a stone on his child's plate. Jesus takes that small, earthly reflex and lifts it until it teaches heaven. If even we, who are evil, give bread and not a stone, how much more will the Father give what is truly good. Goodness is God refusing to mock the hungry. He knows the difference between a gift and a cruelty. Ask as a child asks. Do not come as a customer testing a merchant. Come as one whose Father sets the table.

The Shelter in a Hard Day

Goodness is easy to confess when the field is green. Nahum names it in a day of distress: the Lord is good, a stronghold. The picture is not a picnic. It is a keep when the plain is unsafe—walls that hold, a place to enter, a God who has not changed His heart because the weather has. Trouble does not prove that He has become unkind. It proves that we need a shelter, and that the shelter is still good.

Reflection

These pictures remind us that goodness is God's heart, not His public manners. When glory passes by, it passes as kindness. When a child is hungry, the Father knows bread from a stone. When the day turns hard, He is still a stronghold, not a different God. Because He is good, suspicion loses its office. We taste and see. We ask as children. We run to the keep instead of concluding that trouble has exposed a cruel core.

1. When I ask what God is like at the center, do I start with suspicion—or with the goodness that passed before Moses?
2. What have I been calling a stone that may be bread, or calling bread what His character would never set on the table?
3. In this hard day, am I treating the Shelter as if He had changed, rather than entering the keep that is still good?

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In Christ,

The JesusOnline Ministries Team

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